LAGAPPA UNIVERSITY

(Accredited with A+ Grade by NAAC (CGPA : 3.64) in the Third Cycle) &
Graded as Category-I University by MHRD-UGC)
Karaikudi

Date : 04.04.2018

Address by the Hon'ble Vice-Chancellor Prof.S.Subbiah to the Press Reporters on 04.04.2018

Alagappa University, Karaikudi, has secured the 27th position among the "Universities Category" and 43rd position under the "Overall Category" among the 1192 higher educational institutions at the national level ranking taken up in the National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF) 2018.

In the last NIRF 2017 ranking, Alagappa University was placed at the 97th position in the overall category of higher educational institutions but now it has been elevated to 27th position.

Prof. S. Subbiah, Vice-Chancellor, who attended the Release Function in New Delhi on 3.4.2018, on invitation from the Ministry of Human Resource Development (MHRD), told the Press that Alagappa University could achieve this owing to a number of quality and innovative academic measures implemented during the previous year. He attributed this to the coordinated efforts of both academic and administrative staff and also to the development of instructional and infrastructural facilities.

The Vice-Chancellor added that the following parameters were adopted while ranking the universities –- 1) Teaching, Learning and Resources 2) Research and Professional Practice 3) Graduation Outcomes 4) Outreach and Inclusivity and 5) Perception.

It may be recalled that NIRF ranking has been done by the MHRD from 2016 onwards and this is the third year of ranking.

The Vice-Chancellor recalled the circumstances that led to these awards Alagappa University, which was awarded 'A Plus' grade by the National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC) became the only university in Tamil Nadu to obtain 3.64 Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) on the four-point scale.

Alagappa University was one of the youngest institutions to secure this grade and score over other universities in Tamil Nadu. This grade awarded in the third cycle of accreditation would be valid for a period of seven years with effect from May 2, 2017.

In a historic decision announced in March 2018, the UGC has granted autonomy to all Category-I status universities including Alagappa University. Based on the NAAC score for maintaining high academic standards that include sophisticated science laboratories, experienced and committed faculty, good physical and IT infrastructure, eco-friendly environment, linkages with local industries, augmented placement services, skill training across several sectors and good alumni support Alagappa University has been granted autonomy. Alagappa University is holding the**SECOND** position among the 12 State Universities in India under Category-I status.

Recently, MHRD has sanctioned a special scheme of "Enhancing quality and excellence in select 10 State Universities" with an allocation of Rs.100 Crores each under RUSA-Phase II and Alagappa University is eligible to receive Rs.100 Crores under RUSA-Phase II. Further, 50 universities will get Rs.20 Crores each under RUSA infrastructure grants and Alagappa University is also eligible to get this grant.

Union Minister of Human Resource Development, Shri Prakash Javadekar, released the NIRF India Rankings 2018 in various categories on the basis of performance of Higher Educational Institutions in a function held in New Delhi on 03.04.2018. Alagappa University has secured 27th position among the Universities in India and 43rd position among 1192 higher educational institutions in India. It is to be noted that Alagappa University is elevated from 97th position in NIRF-2017 Ranking to 27th position in NIRF-2018 Ranking. This paradigm shift is due to the implementation of quality measures in developing instructional and infrastructural facilities by the University in the last two years. The idea behind these rankings is to promote quality in education and encourage competition to perform better and to set up new benchmarks of performance in higher education sphere.

The MHRD Minister said that to promote quality education, the Government is providing support for setting up and upgrading of 10 public and 10 private Institutions of Eminence (IOEs) so as to enable them to find places among the top 100 world institutions. The list of 20 IOEs will be released soon by the Government. Alagappa University has submitted the proposal for IOE status in December 2017 to obtain this status with Rs.1000 crore funding owing to achievements made in factors such as:

(i) A+ Grade by NAAC : **3.64 awarded out of 4**
(ii)Category-I status by MHRD-UGC : **Category I status given**
(iii) University Autonomous Status : **Autonomy given** and
(iv) MHRD-NIRF 2018 Ranking within 50 ranks : **Obtained 27th rank**

Alagappa University is the only State University that has fulfilled all the requirements.

Prof. H. Gurumallesh Prabu

Registrar